

GOING AGAINST THE “FLOE”: THE INTERSECTION OF POWER, CULTURE, AND COMMUNITY AT ICY STRAIT POINT, ALASKA

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Port development has been dominated by complex and often unequal power relations. This study explores the tangled relationship between ports, host communities, and cruise companies by examining the contested nature of the pier expansion at Icy Strait Point, Alaska. This study collected data based on a keyword search of existing texts from multiple sources to better understand the impacts of tourism development on the local community and X’una Kaawu. Thematic analysis revealed key findings of power, access and exclusion, and the shifting Indigenous focus and commodification of X’una Kaawu culture. The blue economy is used as a framework to critically examine the pier expansion and provides a unique theoretical approach for examining tourism development at a cruise port. This study provides a practical contribution by identifying challenges for port communities when attempting to balance social and economic opportunities with development as a cruise destination and a theoretical contribution by adding to the literature on Indigenous tourism and cruise port development. Icy Strait Point is a successful Indigenous tourism destination in Alaska, but the implications of further development highlight the difficulties facing the local community and the need to address power imbalances.

Key words: Cruise; Indigenous; Power; Tourism; Alaska

Introduction

Cruise tourism can offer social and economic benefits to a port community such as empowerment, improved education and facilities, and promotion of local culture (Dowling & Weeden, 2017). However, the development of cruise tourism also has the potential for adverse consequences including loss of community coherence, degradation of local

culture, growth in crime, loss of access to facilities for local people (Newsome et al., 2012), and negative social and economic impacts (Brida & Zapata, 2010; Jones et al., 2016; Klein, 2011; Lloret et al., 2021; Wondirad, 2019). Often there is an unequal distribution of economic impacts and environmental impacts (Römhild-Raviart et al., 2019) including pollution (Carić et al., 2016; Howitt et al., 2010; Randone et al., 2019) and poor destination

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stewardship (Delgado, 2017; Klein, 2011; McCarthy, 2018a, 2018b; Perućić, 2020; Sanz-Blas et al., 2019).

Cruise companies have a significant impact on a local community by choosing whether to visit or to avoid it (Bunten, 2015; London & Lohrmann, 2014), with cruise terminals impacting the economic and sociocultural sustainability of a destination (Santos et al., 2019). Small developing ports often lack the resources to challenge the normative practices of large cruise corporations in pressuring small communities into development. For example, communities that have tried unsuccessfully to prevent further cruise development include Florida's Key West (McGillivray, 2022), French Polynesia, and Grand Cayman (Laird, 2021). Some scholars have noted the complex web of interrelationships specifically within cruise destination development (Adams, 2010; Bunten, 2015; Cervený, 2004, 2005; Lester & Weeden, 2004; London & Lohrmann, 2014; Weeden, 2015). This includes the power cruise companies can exert as multinational corporations on small, developing countries (Johnson, 2002; Lester & Weeden, 2004) including the use of purchasing power, threats to discontinue use of the port, and control of access to tourism opportunities (Bunten, 2015; Clancy, 2017; McKee & Chase, 2003). The power also extends to the unequal distribution of benefits within the destination community (Cervený et al., 2020; Klein, 2011). Although cruise companies occasionally build and develop port infrastructure (Pallis et al., 2014) that can provide employment and opportunities for entrepreneurial development, there is typically little investment and benefits returning to the local community (see Brida et al., 2012; Larsen et al., 2013; McCaughey et al., 2018). Although private concessions and agreements between port authorities and cruise lines occur in some regions such as the Mediterranean (Gui & Russo, 2011), more often power is exerted on a destination to develop and build or expand infrastructure for a new terminal with the cost borne by local authorities or public-private partnerships where cruise companies rarely participate or assume risk (Clancy, 2017; London & Lohrmann, 2014).

More research is needed on understanding the power exerted by the cruise sector in relation to cruise destinations and how this affects port

development. Few studies examine this beyond Cervený (2004, 2005), Clancy (2017), and London and Lohrmann (2014). A long-term concession with a port benefits a cruise line by securing berthing priorities, controls costs, and increases satisfaction of passengers by not requiring tenders to access the destination (London & Lohrmann, 2014). However, some scholars criticize the incentives and argue they are subsidizing the cruise lines (Cheong, 2013; Clancy, 2017; Peisley, 2013).

Development of cruise ports in Alaska has been dominated by complex and often unequal power relations between cruise companies and local communities. In Southeast Alaska, as in other regions such as the Arctic and Australia, Indigenous communities are looking to tourism to shape and guide the future (see Cervený et al., 2020; James et al., 2020; Lemelin et al., 2012; Ruhanen & Whitford, 2019). Tourism can foster and sustain cultural heritage including preserving Indigenous culture, knowledge, and traditions (Ruhanen & Whitford, 2019) but this presents challenges in relation to the commodification and commercialization of culture and potential impacts on the community. Several cruise ports in Alaska have a rich Indigenous culture and heritage yet there are few studies on how the development of cruise tourism has impacted the Indigenous communities who live and work in these ports. Bunten (2015) provided rare insight into Sitka through her experiences of being Unangan and Yup'ik while working at an Indigenous-centered local tour company in Alaska. In many ports, the Indigenous perspective is silent and little is known if or how Indigenous communities benefit or are impacted by the cruise industry.

More research is needed on cruise tourism in Southeast Alaska as cruising has had an enormous impact socially and economically on the port communities, with both negative and positive impacts. This article builds on the extensive work of Cervený (2004, 2007), Cervený et al. (2020), Hillmer-Pegram (2016), and Wanasuk and Thornton (2015), who have highlighted the specific issues facing Icy Strait Point [ISP] and Southeast Alaska. This article moves the literature forward by using the blue economy framework to critically examine the pier expansion at ISP and, in doing so, provides a different theoretical approach for examining tourism development. ISP is an example of specific

challenges communities may face and the blue economy provides an anchor for the discussion, which has yet to be widely applied in cruise or coastal tourism research. The blue economy framework highlights the intersectionality of social, economic, and environmental impacts on communities connected with the ocean and political economy in relation to port development. Rooted in principles of sustainability, the blue economy framework espouses development that provides economic benefit but also conservation of cultural landscapes and the marine environments. This aligns with other scholars considering tourism as an opportunity for enhancing the social, cultural, and place identity of Indigenous peoples (Carr et al., 2016). ISP is also unique as the entire port development is an Indigenous tourism enterprise, which is rare. This provides practical implications and lessons that can be learned for other communities and offers insight into the politics at play in port selection and development.

The pier expansion will result in significant political, social, and economic changes for the X'una Kaawu (people with Indigenous Hoonah lineage; Hoonah Indian Association [HIA], 2018). This article illuminates the complex relationship and power struggles between cruise companies and local communities, particularly in relation to the challenges encountered by Indigenous peoples and the X'una Kaawu especially. Indigenous tourism is increasingly being recognized as providing opportunity for empowerment (Sarr et al., 2021) and independence with benefits related to social, cultural, political, environmental, and economic purposes (Higgins-Desbiolles et al., 2014). However, scholars also recognize the complex relationships between Indigenous groups and the political and economic structures in which tourism operates (Bunten & Graburn, 2018).

Issues of power and stakeholder relationships in cruise tourism have been explored in relation to the Caribbean (Lester & Weeden, 2004; Weaver & Lawton, 2017), New Zealand (London et al., 2017), the Mediterranean (Brida et al., 2012), and Antarctica (Liggett et al., 2010). Weaver and Lawton (2017) in particular identified the need for more critical inquiry into the contested spaces in ports of call. London et al. (2017) questioned the political nature of how port sites are selected, revealing the

lack of transparency by those wanting to develop cruise infrastructure. A gap exists in applying this to Alaska, which has seen sustained growth and development for decades in relation to cruise tourism but with little critical analysis, particularly around port selection and expansion. Therefore, the aim of this research is to explore the complex and unequal relationships between ports, communities, and cruise tourism through critically examining the contested nature of the pier expansion at ISP.

Literature Review

This article draws on the blue economy concept, which promotes sustainable use of oceans and coastal resources where economic and social needs are balanced (Colgan, 2018). Using the blue economy to underpin this research assists in unravelling the complex relationship between the many groups affected by activities and development at ISP, with use of the coastal areas and cruise tourism as integral to the discussion. The blue economy (Smith-Godfrey, 2016) provides a framework for situating the globalized nature and mobility of cruise tourism, and the intersectionality of social, economic, and environmental impacts on communities connected with the ocean. The concept of the blue economy suggests a paradigm shift moving away from the current red ocean strategy where resources are exploited, businesses compete for existing market space, and profit and growth are key objectives (Attri & Bohler-Muller, 2018; Kim & Mauborgne, 2005). Schutter and Hicks (2019) noted the triple bottom line within the blue economy with benefits for a community balanced between economic growth, environmental sustainability, and social equity. The blue economy seeks to alleviate poverty and hunger, encourage gender equality, and harness the power of the ocean in a sustainable manner (Attri & Bohler-Muller, 2018). Consumers have become more aware of the impact of their purchase decisions and are seeking out more sustainable choices, with travelers especially becoming increasingly aware of the power of their choices and the impacts of their travel behavior (Hanna et al., 2017). Potential cruise consumers consider corporate social responsibility in relation to reputation and trust when making purchase decisions (Ahn et al., 2021) and prefer companies

with sustainable social and environmental policies and practices (Adams et al., 2017). Framed by the blue economy concept, this research examines the power relationships between the cruise industry, local communities, and port entities while discussing the use of the ocean for cruise tourism and the challenges for Indigenous communities developing cruise tourism.

Research Context

Cruise Tourism in Alaska

Alaska is the 4th most visited cruise destination globally (Cruise Lines International Association [CLIA], 2019a) with sustained growth over the last two decades. The cruise sector in Alaska in 2019 was worth an estimated \$1.4 billion and accounted for 22,477 jobs in 5.65 million passenger visits (CLIA, 2019b). Cruise tourism in Alaska accounted for 90% of tourist arrivals and 1.33 million visitors in 2019 (Rain Coast Data, 2020). Notably 28% of these arrivals visited the X'una Kaawu village of ISP (Rain Coast Data, 2019). Prior to the pandemic, projections indicated ISP was forecast to experience the strongest growth of all ports in Alaska (Rain Coast Data, 2019) and the cruise sector was the fastest growing sector of the global tourism industry (Papathanassis, 2020). New ports are needed to meet increasing demand for varied and new cruise itineraries to retain and attract customers (Peručić, 2020; Rodrigue & Notteboom, 2013), particularly as the cruise industry matures and the highly competitive nature of the sector (Weeden et al., 2011).

Site Selection

ISP was selected for the research site as it is an Indigenous tourism enterprise owned and operated as a subsidiary of Huna Totem and the X'una Kaawu as a privately owned cruise port in Southeast Alaska. Prior to the port expansion, which is the focus of this study, the port included a restored 1912 salmon cannery housing an interactive heritage museum focusing on local fishing and Indigenous history, 12 shops, 3 restaurants featuring locally caught fish, a zip-line, bear viewing platform, and a boardwalk trail.

Privately owned cruise ports are rare, and even more unusual, ISP is owned and operated by the Huna Totem Corporation for the local Indigenous community. Huna Totem Corporation (Huna Totem) is a for-profit entity with 1,360 shareholders, all of whom have an Indigenous connection to Hoonah and the Glacier Bay region of Alaska (Wanasuk & Thornton, 2015). Native corporations are a legacy from the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act of 1971 to settle land claims and provide economic opportunity through both village and regional corporations (Yang, 2006). The stated mission of Huna Totem is "To advance the economic aspirations and culture of the X'una Kaawu through business excellence, sustainable economic growth, leadership, and education" (Huna Totem Corporation, 2022). The port is 1.6 miles from Hoonah, which is recognized as the largest Tlingit village in Southeast Alaska (HIA, 2018).

The X'una Kaawu are one of several tribes who have lived in the Pacific Northwest region of North America prior to European contact (Schurr et al., 2012). In 2018 there were 800 residents in Hoonah, with 55.87% of the population identifying as American Indian and Alaska Native (United States Census Bureau, 2018). Hoonah City council is involved with port development through regulatory processes and administration of permits and land leases for activities and development and also funds or subsidizes infrastructure within the region. The city of Hoonah receives a share of the State of Alaska Commercial Passenger Vessel Excise Tax, which at \$5 per passenger generated \$688,980 in 2016 and receives funding from Huna Totem for an additional \$5 per passenger head tax, which in 2017 generated \$722,575 (Sheinberg Associates, 2016). The city also benefits financially in direct contributions from ISP, and in 2017 that amounted to an additional \$846,946 spent locally, with a total economic contribution of \$4.3 million (Icy Strait Point, 2018). Cruise tourism has provided an economic boost to Hoonah in terms of investment, employment, and tourist spending.

Tlingit culture is incorporated in all aspects of ISP and all tour guides share X'una Kaawu history and stories (American Indian Alaska Native Tourism Association [AIANTA], 2018). As part of training, all guides receive 2 days of cultural training including Tlingit protocols and introductions, the

history of the community, and important aspects for Alaska Natives including the Alaska Native Brotherhood and the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act (AIANTA, 2018). Hoonah is situated on Chichagof Island, Alaska, which is accessible only by air or by sea and thereby limiting tourism development.

Developing Cruise Tourism at Icy Strait Point

As traditional resource-based employment started to decline in the early 2000s, tourism was viewed by many as an opportunity to provide economic stability (Cervený, 2007) and is often viewed as an economic panacea (Vogt et al., 2016). Prior to 2004, there were very few tourism activities on the island. This is in contrast to nearby Alaskan cruise ports Juneau, Ketchikan, and Skagway, which at that time were seeing robust growth and increasing visitor numbers. The prevalence of several cruise lines in the region and few alternative revenue opportunities for ISP highlights the imbalanced power relationship that tends to favor cruise companies (Weeden, 2015). Haines is a cautionary example of an Alaskan port trying to attract cruise ships and eventually invested \$1.5 million to modify the dock in 1994 to accommodate larger cruise ships (see Cervený, 2004). Local businesses in Haines were becoming increasingly dependent on cruise visitors, with local residents and wildlife negatively impacted such that a coalition of environmental groups protested and demanded dialogue with the cruise lines (see Cervený, 2004). In response, the town imposed a 4% tax on tours and in 1999 chose to limit the number of cruise ships to what the town felt was a manageable level, which led to several cruise lines dropping Haines in 2000 (Adams, 2010; Cervený, 2004). Haines has still not recovered with few cruise lines calling in even two decades later. Similar attempts to levy a head tax per passenger in the Alaskan port of Sitka failed, with Holland America retaliating by changing itineraries from six ships with 108 calls a year in Sitka to just three ships with 54 calls (Bunten, 2015). These examples illuminate the unequal power cruise lines can exert over a community, particularly if they become dependent on cruise tourists. Power relations can impact emerging community-based tourism settings, causing conflict when there is a dominant industry (Reed, 1997).

Significance of Glacier Bay

One of the main attractions for cruise passengers to Southeast Alaska is Glacier Bay National Park (Glacier Bay). Significantly, Glacier Bay is the ancestral homeland of the X'una Kaawu and Hoonah is the first recorded permanent settlement in this area (Goldschmidt & Haas, 1998). The park was created through the Antiquities Act in the US in 1925 (Rumore, 2012) when the region was expropriated by the US federal government for conservation. The park was further expanded in the 1980s with the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act, which was bitterly opposed by local communities (Hunn et al., 2003). The federal regulatory nature of Glacier Bay is also interwoven with resentment from some X'una Kaawu and viewed as forced expulsion from their land by colonization (Hunn et al., 2003) and prohibited from subsistence activities.

In 1996, Huna Totem purchased the land encompassing the port and adjacent Spasski Creek area with the intention to develop the site for tourism. This site eventually became Icy Strait Point. Huna Totem sought exclusive partnerships with cruise lines as early as 1999 (Cervený, 2007), with the first large cruise ship arriving in ISP in 2000. Cervený's (2007) study found the local community of Hoonah was reticent with concerns about developing cruise tourism. While tourism was promoted as providing economic benefits with opportunities to share and strengthen Indigenous culture (recognized by Carr et al., 2016, as a potential positive outcome of tourism development), residents were concerned about safety and potential societal changes (Cervený, 2007). Destination communities may face challenges arising from cruise ship visitation, which can affect the social fabric of the community and raise questions about community identity (Brida & Zapata, 2010; Cervený, 2008; Klein, 2011). These concerns are not unfounded as Wanasuk and Thornton (2015) identified negative impacts as a result of Indigenous tourism can include loss of self-esteem, loss of community character, locals' lives being controlled by tourists' demands, internal conflicts in the community, disrespectful behavior, and loss of Native identity. Additionally, Cervený (2007) and Cervený et al. (2020) noted concerns over the impact more tourists and large cruise ships would

have on the ecology and environment in Southeast Alaska, particularly in relation to fears about being able to access critically important food sources to maintain a subsistence lifestyle.

Since opening in 2004, the port remains the only privately owned cruise port in Alaska (Huna Totem, 2020). This is in contrast to other cruise ports where multinational corporations own and operate most of the passenger facilities with little revenue returning to the community (see Cheong, 2013; de Grosbois, 2016). Klein (2005) found cruise lines retain as much as 70% of the profit of shore excursions, and in Alaska many shops will lose 40% of their revenue in fees to cruise lines as commission (Klein, 2005). Several cruise lines have developed extensive strategies of vertical integration where they own or invest in accommodation, transportation, restaurants, gift shops, tour operators, and services and are able to operate at a lower cost than local entrepreneurs (see Behnke, 1999; Cervený, 2004). As an illustration, Carnival Corporation acquired the White Pass Scenic Railway in Alaska including the railway line, train terminals, and retail operations (Carnival Corporation, 2018). This is significant as this affects access and exerts power in the region.

Pier Expansion

As a larger pier for cruise ships was deemed to be necessary to meet and capitalize on the increasing demand for new and unique ports in Southeast Alaska, Huna Totem partnered with Norwegian Cruise Line Holdings [NCLH] in 2018 (CLIA, 2019c). The partnership agreed to expand the port development by adding a second purpose-built cruise dock, restaurants, welcome center, tour departure lounge, expanded hiking trails, suspension bridge, and gondola (cable car) system. The first phase of development was completed in 2016, with the second pier opening in August 2021 (Bretz, 2021). Until the partnership with NCLH, Huna Totem managed and operated the port and facilities (Huna Totem, 2020) and exercised total control over their own pier, deciding how many ships to allow in at any one time to avoid overcapacity. This was in direct contrast to many other Alaskan ports that maximize revenue by having as many ships as possible. For example, Juneau rarely has less than

four ships in and often has seven cruise ships in on the same day (Cruise Line Agencies of Alaska [CLAA], 2022a).

ISP has enjoyed continued growth with one in three cruise ship tourists in Alaska visiting annually (Resneck, 2019). ISP is very popular with passengers and provides a competitive edge for cruise companies who include it on their itineraries. There are 16 different ocean cruise companies that regularly visit ISP as part of an Alaskan itinerary in addition to several boutique and expedition cruise companies and independent charters that also call in. The Alaska season is from May until September. Prior to the COVID-19 pandemic, 2020 was forecast to be the most successful season yet with 500,000 visitors (Huna Totem, 2020) and there were 161 calls scheduled for 2021, reflecting the continued growth of the port. However, as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic and Canada's ban on most cruise ships (Transport Canada, 2021), no ships were able to visit in 2020 and only 27 smaller ships visited in 2021 (Icy Strait Point, 2021a). In 2022 there were 209 scheduled calls (CLAA, 2021) but the destination has received a greater number of ships due to increased demand with more people choosing to cruise Alaska after the pandemic and some lines seeing record bookings (Cruise Industry News, 2022). ISP has also received more calls in 2022 as a result of the safety issues from several landslides at the cruise ship dock in Skagway and ships diverted to other nearby ports (Williams, 2022). This resulted in a total of 252 calls in ISP in 2022 (CLAA, 2022b). Notably, 25 days had three ships calling with at least 7,000 passengers going ashore on the same day. There were also 10 days with four ships, resulting in the potential for a staggering 16,000 passengers coming ashore on the same day. This is a significant increase from one ship a day with around 2,000 passengers ashore, which was what residents had preferred (Cervený, 2004). The new dock also changes the nature of the port experience as more ships calling in at the same time will significantly change the on-shore passenger experience. Potentially high number of cruise ship visitors can put pressure on local resources, infrastructure, and facilities, and result in congestion (Brida & Zapata, 2010; James et al., 2020) and lack of privacy for residents and other negative social impacts (Wanasuk & Thornton, 2015).

The next section identifies the methodology used to address the aim of the research.

Methodology

This project explored the complex relationship of cruise tourism in Alaska between cruise companies, Huna Totem, and community of Hoonah by examining ISP and the contested nature of the pier expansion. Data were systematically gathered from existing texts using keywords to understand the context surrounding the pier expansion and to identify potential impacts. The keywords used in the search were pier, ISP, Huna Totem, HIA, and Hoonah. The time frame of 2005 to 2021 was selected as most relevant to the growth and development of ISP and cruise tourism in Southeast Alaska, and included the time period leading up to the pier expansion. Data were collected from secondary sources that were publicly available through library and internet searches. Multiple sources of information were gathered including documents from the state of Alaska and government agencies, published media interviews with ISP employees, correspondence between the Hoonah city council and cruise companies, council documents, published presentations, and reports from Huna Totem and Hoonah Economic Development. Additionally, data were collected from Alaska news and cruise industry reports, and contextualized in relation to previous studies on tourism development in Hoonah and Southeast Alaska (see Cervený, 2007; Cervený et al., 2020; Hillmer-Pegram, 2016; Wanasuk & Thornton, 2015).

A researcher's positionality is a central component of qualitative research (Ganga & Scott, 2006) and informs all stages including development of research questions, methodology, data collection, and ultimately analysis and interpretation. The positionality of the researcher in this study is notable as the researcher's own experience and personal connection to the research guided the interest in the topic, research process, and how meaning is constructed. The researcher is situated as "insider" within the cruise industry but as "outsider" to the X'una Kaawu and the issues facing this community. The researcher visited the port and town prior to the commencement of this research in 2010 during employment with a cruise line. The researcher

is no longer employed in the cruise industry but has remained embedded within the sector as a researcher. As the researcher is non-Indigenous with European cultural values and this research focuses on the X'una Kaawu people and community of Hoonah, a reflexive approach was needed that acknowledged the insider/outside discourse and historic marginalization and misrepresentation of Indigenous people and their cultures (Kwame, 2017). This approach involved using reflexive memos as the data was being collected and analyzed to identify any theoretical assumptions or presuppositions. Reflexivity was considered both methodologically and ontologically (see Haynes, 2012), such that how did being a non-Indigenous researcher looking at issues facing an Indigenous community underpin the theoretical position and methodology used. Ontologically, the researcher lives in a country deeply affected by the marginalization of Indigenous people and this affected the researcher's nature of reality and ways of seeing the world. The original research impetus was to highlight a positive example of a successful Indigenous tourism enterprise, but as the research progressed the researcher uncovered unequal power relations and was challenged to address the negative impacts and social change the pier expansion will bring to the community.

Data Analysis

The researcher followed guidelines for analyzing qualitative data (Bloomberg & Volpe, 2018; Braun & Clarke, 2006) by looking for emergent patterns about the relationship between development of cruise tourism, the pier, X'una Kaawu, and the wider community. Data were selected based on how the pier expansion and further development of ISP will impact the X'una Kaawu and Hoonah communities. The researcher followed the process of thematic analysis as outlined by Braun and Clarke (2006, 2021).

First, the researcher became immersed in the data through multiple readings of each text, making comments in the margins, and making reflexive notes on the latent meaning and any further considerations. The notes also were a space for reflection on the researcher's thoughts, feelings, and challenges due to her positionality.

Second, the texts were coded to generate initial codes. The researcher used colored highlighters to identify phrases, words, and ideas that related to the pier expansion, the local community in Hoonah, and ISP. The coding specifically examined the data by considering the underlying meaning of the extract. Coding decisions were based on various elements of the content, including both the manifest and latent meaning (Roller & Lavrakas, 2015). At this stage, the researcher highlighted all potential aspects related to the research aim.

Third, the researcher organized the data into an Excel worksheet. The first column listed an aspect or initial code related to ISP, Hoonah, X’una Kaawu, and the pier expansion, and the second column contained the corresponding data extract that illustrated this aspect. All of the initial codes and extracts were entered in the worksheet. After reviewing all the initial codes and extracts from the worksheet, a total of 19 codes were identified.

Fourth, the next step sorted related codes into potential subthematic groups in order to begin to see patterns and similarities. This was done by copying and moving similar codes into a new excel worksheet. For example, code 1 (new pier) and code 2 (cost) and the corresponding extracts were placed in a worksheet, and once placed in this way, the subtheme of “economic impact” emerged. This same process was done with the remaining 17 codes

and led to the researcher creating eight worksheets with each containing codes and extracts related to a potential subtheme. Through this process the researcher identified eight subthemes. These subthemes were listed in chronological order of how they emerged during the process.

Fifth, the researcher created a final Excel worksheet. In this worksheet, all eight potential subthemes were listed in column 1 along with extract examples. This assisted the researcher to reexamine the data extracts and subthemes in order to see patterns emerging. The researcher deemed using this process of sorting the data in a systematic and orderly manner to be a useful way to manage the data in an organized and methodological manner. This also fostered an iterative and thoughtful consideration of the data through reexamining and considering the subthemes multiple times. There was a constant comparison and iteration over many months and the analysis revealed three main themes. The first theme, *Power*, was revealed through the interplay between the subthemes of economic impacts related to the cost to build and future growth but also political pressure and influence from the cruise lines. The second theme, *Access*, was revealed through the exclusion of residents for access and the port site as an enclave designed to both keep the cruise tourists in and the local residents out. This theme also revealed the expropriation of cultural

Code	Subtheme	Theme
New pier	Economic impacts	Power
Cost		
Business owners	Political pressure	
Cruise Lines		
Access to town		Access
Access to Spasski Point	Impacts on residents	
Glacier Bay		
Subsistence		
Cannery as heritage	Port site as enclave	X’una Kaawu culture
Communal ownership		
Cruise passengers		
Move cultural items	Expropriation	
Shore excursions	Commercialization	
Culture loss		
Museum		
White history	Colonial status quo	
Outsiders		Positive opportunities
Indigenous products		
Local businesses		

Figure 1. Analysis process.

artifacts as some of these items were moved to the port area, further illuminating the significance of access. The third theme, *X'una Kaawu Culture*, was revealed through the intersection of commercialization and cultural preservation as an outcome of tourism development at ISP. This theme emerged through the relationship between commercialization as evidenced in the shore excursions and museum, with the colonial status quo undercurrent that affects the perpetuation of “outsiders” in management roles, and a focus on shore excursions that promote “White” history and landscapes rather than Indigenous culture. This theme also includes the emergence of positive opportunities for the X'una Kaawu and Tlingit through development of Indigenous products for sale and fostering of local entrepreneurs and small businesses. The codes, subthemes and themes are identified in Figure 1.

Analysis of these themes revealed specific findings that provide insight into the complex relationships between the local community, port, and cruise companies.

Findings

Three key findings that emerged from the pier expansion are: 1) power relations in site selection, 2) exclusion and access, and 3) loss of Indigenous focus. These are now discussed in turn.

Power Relations in Site Selection

In spite of COVID-19, the new pier opened in 2021 and was financed through a \$15 million loan from the Alaska Industrial Development and Export Authority [AIDEA] with Huna Totem paying the balance on the total cost of \$23.7 million (AIDEA, 2019; Isenbek, 2014). Notably, the terms of the partnership between Huna Totem and NCLH unsurprisingly have not been publicly disclosed and it is difficult to determine how much of the infrastructure costs will be shared with NCLH. NCLH (and associated brands Oceania Cruises and Regent Seven Seas Cruises) will have preferential berthing rights and the partnership will be in place until 2029 (Kalosh, 2019). The partnership highlights the power of the cruise lines in negotiating agreements for shared ownership and preferential access of cruise terminals but with potentially little

investment. The expansion of the second pier will also create an additional 60 new seasonal jobs at ISP (AIDEA, 2019).

The site of the pier was contested with differing preferences between different stakeholders. The first option was to expand the original existing Cannery Dock at ISP but was deemed impractical due to the shallow depth of the water and other structural constraints. This original dock did not allow cruise ships to moor alongside and required all passengers to use tenders to come ashore. The new pier needed to accommodate both cruise and cargo ships to better benefit the community. Hoonah City Council preferred a second option with the new pier to be built on city land at Shaman Point as this had existing roads and services and was nearest to the city and would benefit local businesses more (City of Hoonah, 2012; Kelly, 2012). However, the council faced external pressure from cruise companies and Huna Totem to move it to a third option at Outer Point (City of Hoonah, 2012). The site selection caused tension and conflict between two specific cruise companies that were competing for access. Prior to the new arrangement with NCLH, Huna Totem had a deal with Royal Caribbean Cruise Lines [RCCL] where more than 80% of the cruise ships allotted access were either RCCL or associated brand Celebrity (Kelly, 2012). During negotiations, a Royal Caribbean executive wrote to the city council expressing concerns over Shaman Point (Ruby, 2012), and went as far as to say that if Shaman Point was selected, RCCL and Celebrity would be unwilling to use the new pier and would continue to use the existing tender pier at the cannery as the cruise lines want “Direct, immediate access to Icy Strait Point.” In other correspondence it was revealed RCCL rejected Shaman Point because of the additional cost to run a shuttle bus to the cannery site (City of Hoonah, 2012). This refusal is significant as the ongoing costs for the pier would be financed through landing and port fees, meaning there would be more financial burden on Huna Totem and the City Council if several cruise lines refused to use it. This supports Clancy’s (2017) assertion cruise companies regularly threaten to exit a port to get favorable market conditions. Ultimately an agreement was made between Huna Totem and NCLH for the development of the new pier, and this will

have wide impacts on the community by more than doubling the current number of cruise passengers visiting the port. The enormous political, social, and economic change by the development of the second pier cannot be overstated. This arrangement also changes the power dynamics between Huna Totem and the cruise lines with more power allotted to NCLH. Even before this partnership and increased capacity, Hoonah residents worried about the control cruise lines have over communities (Cervený, 2007). This is noted through the costs to build and maintain a port facility with a growing dependency on cruise companies. Cruise lines also often exert power implicitly through community projects in port communities through corporate philanthropy to deflect criticism (see Weeden, 2015). For example, NCLH donated \$2 million to the city of Hoonah to help keep services open through the pandemic (Huna Totem Corporation, 2021). NCLH does not appear to be contributing resources for the building of the pier but are promising ship visits as a way to wield leverage in return for preferential access.

Communities need to fund maintenance and infrastructure costs, often through additional taxes, but the cruise lines often exert pressure to avoid paying them. For example, in 2008 the state of Alaska tried to impose a \$46 pp head tax on cruise passengers, and at the time the cruise industry responded by repositioning ships away from Alaska to exercise power and avoid paying the tax (Bohrer, 2010). After the tax had been removed, several cruise lines returned and expanded operations within Alaska. Even between ports increased costs can cause competition, and port cities are aware that cruise lines will drop a port of they feel it is less profitable or too costly (Bunten, 2015). In 2016, Hoonah imposed their own port head tax of \$5 pp on cruise passengers to help cover infrastructure costs, and as a result five cruise ships responded by removing ISP and replaced it with Sitka (City of Hoonah, 2016). This threat of exit has been noted by Clancy (2017) as the cruise ships are easily moved to manage market conditions and avoid additional costs a destination may try to impose. This reflects the geomobility of the blue economy, and further illustrates the power of a cruise company to simply move a ship to where more favorable market conditions are. This demonstrates the power cruise

lines can exert over destinations to secure the most profit (London & Lohrmann, 2014), and especially in Northern communities that are forced to adapt to the demands of cruise companies (Sletvold, 2014), with port communities questioning the attractiveness of accommodating cruise ships (Vogt et al., 2016).

Exclusion and Access

A second key finding relates to concerns of the local community feeling excluded or having difficulty accessing culturally significant places. In Indigenous northern communities, culture and social structure are tied to the natural environment with recreation, economic, and family activities dependent on access to resources (Notzke, 1999). Increased tourism activities in Glacier Bay have resulted in limitations placed on nearby residents as private vessels are restricted and required to obtain a permit to enter (National Park Service, 2003, 2022). When speaking with Hoonah residents, Cervený (2007) found they felt displaced by the tourism activities and felt they had been “‘pushed out of Glacier Bay by the government . . . Glacier Bay was taken away from them by the federal government and given to the tourists’” (p. 48). Indigenous peoples share a history of displacement particularly after creation of a National Park (Sarr et al., 2021), marginalization, and are disadvantaged by colonial systems of occupation, colonization, and settlement (Higgins-Desbiolles et al., 2014), and the US as a settler-colonial state includes this narrative. The US initially voted against Article 26 of the United Nations declaration, which asserts that Indigenous Peoples have the right to own, use, develop, and control the lands, territories, and resources they have traditionally owned, occupied, or otherwise used or acquired (United Nations, 2007). The initial refusal to support this declaration by the US, Australia, New Zealand, and Canada impacted the ability of Indigenous Peoples to manage and control their traditionally held territories (Weaver, 2010). However, all four countries have since signed the declaration with Canada being the last party to do so in 2021 (Government of Canada, 2021).

In addition to Glacier Bay, the X'una Kaawu have limited or no access to the port area including the cannery site, beach, and Spasski Point. The

cannery site is fenced off and local community members are not allowed to access the beach area for recreation or ceremonial uses, and this use of fencing to create an enclave only the cruise tourists can access is seen at other cruise ports (see Dowling & Weeden, 2017). This exclusion is in part due to port maritime security requirements in accordance with the International Ship and Port Facility Security Code [ISPS] (International Maritime Organization, 2003). Fencing and physical barriers around ports are required as part of the ISPS code for safety and security implemented in 2004 to prevent unauthorized access to port facilities or ships and minimizes risk of potential terror activities or use of weapons or explosives. However, the cannery and Sophia Point are important sites for the community for recreation and family gatherings as well as of historical and cultural significance (Cervený, 2007) and there could be ways to accommodate both the port security requirements and the community needs. In this way, community concerns could be addressed through greater collaboration. This restrictive access illuminates the competing and unreconcilable differing views of land ownership and demonstrates the complexity of stakeholder relationships in port areas. X'una Kaawu view ownership as land, and resources are not owned by an individual, but use is assigned based on tribal and clan affiliation (Cervený, 2007). If land ownership is communal and for all to share, the use of fences and barriers to keep the X'una Kaawu from accessing areas used for recreation, hunting, and places of meaning is significant. This may contribute to feeling excluded and impacts survival if unable to access critical food sources.

The pier expansion creates even more of an enclavic setting designed to keep the cruise passengers and spending on site, in what Clancy (2017) described as revenue capture. The ISP port area is similarly deliberately designed to discourage and prevent cruise passengers from leaving. Cervený (2007) noted Hoonah was removed from maps given out onboard to cruise passengers to discourage passengers leaving the port area and spending money in the city, and this was also found to still be the case in 2022 on port guides from major cruise lines.

Further evidence of exclusion are cultural items that were moved from the community to the pier,

ostensibly to make the port look more “authentic.” Cervený (2007) found a carved wooden canoe was moved from the school to the port, totem poles were moved from in front of the tribal offices and relocated to the performance center at the cannery, and the clan house was built at ISP. Local residents no longer have access to these important cultural artefacts that are now on display for the tourists as they cannot access the port due to ISPS regulations unless they work there. Thus, these important places and symbolic items are inaccessible to most of the X'una Kaawu residents.

Shifting Indigenous Focus

A third key issue is the shifting and inconsistent Indigenous focus, evidenced specifically in the shore excursions, museum, and employment. When the port first began operating in 2004, the focus was on culture and ISP has been recognized for sharing traditions and X'una Kaawu culture throughout the visitor experience (see SitNews, 2013, for awards). In most Alaskan ports there is little in the way of “authentic” experiences between the local Indigenous community and cruise ship tourists. Few companies exist that are Indigenous centered, with most tour companies not providing any opportunities for learning about Tlingit or X'una Kaawu history and culture with the exception of Tribal Tours in Sitka (Bunten, 2015). ISP used this as a differentiation and unique selling point to “allow visitors to see a living Native community, to learn about Native lifestyle and the impacts of the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act on Tlingit people” (Cervený, 2007, p. 55). The elders in the community share tribal dancing and storytelling with tourists, which provides opportunities for younger community members to gain knowledge and training about cultural values and heritage (Wanasuk & Thornton, 2015). The sharing of this culture through story is important to the X'una Kaawu as a way to share knowledge across generations and is assisting in cultural recovery (Shorty, 2016). Notably, tourism employees receive cultural and Tlingit language training (Wanasuk & Thornton, 2015). The partnership with NCLH and Huna Totem extends to a Cultural Heritage Guide sailing on each NCLH ship cruising to Glacier Bay. Through these initiatives, ISP

has benefited and strengthened the community and culture, reflecting how tourism can act as both an agent of change and an agent of preservation (Notzke, 1999) and an opportunity for empowerment and strengthen identity (Sarr et al., 2021).

While Huna Totem demonstrates commitment to recognizing the cultural voice of the X'una Kaawu, there have been subtle shifts where the Indigenous focus has been decreased for economic gain. When the development opened in 2004, several shore excursions focused on sharing X'una Kaawu history and culture through the museum and interpretive programs. While the port opened with these intentions, there has been a move to offering less tours that focus on X'una Kaawu culture, such that in 2022, very few of the 29 tours offered by a major cruise line focused on Indigenous social or culture aspects. The majority of the tours now offered are wildlife and "adventure" tours.

The HIA originally managed the cultural programs, but this was eventually taken over by Huna Totem. HIA is the tribal government and manages the legal, political, and economic affairs for the X'una Kaawu tribe with the goal to protect, preserve, enhance, and promote Tlingit traditional values, culture, and subsistence resources (HIA, 2020). The HIA were instrumental in developing the museum and interpretive aspects at the cannery (Cervený, 2007), which is now the main building within the port and houses the museum. Not long after opening, the museum was relocated to a smaller room in the cannery to make more room for the gift shop (Cervený, 2007). The gift shop originally sold items created by local Indigenous artisans but then the port moved away from cultural products to focus on selling nonlocal products tourists wanted to buy such as souvenirs without a native motif (Wanasuk & Thornton, 2015). However, more recently this seems to have shifted back to an emphasis on cultural products as the majority of gift shop products in 2021 featured Indigenous and X'una Kaawu motifs and "authentic" Alaskan or locally made items (Icy Strait Point, 2021b).

Prior to the development of ISP, there were concerns from some in the community about being "the other" and becoming a product sold to the tourists. There were fears tourists would look down on the community and subsistence lifestyle (see Cervený, 2007; Wanasuk & Thornton, 2015).

This was also found in Northern Canadian communities considering developing cruise tourism (see Stewart et al., 2015), with fears about different interpretations of culture. Cervený (2007) identified competing cultural frameworks between X'una Kaawu people and their relationship with Glacier Bay, and how this contrasts with the John Muir narrative often promoted in Alaskan tourism. She notes in her study of Hoonah that some of the X'una Kaawu elders shared they felt that the interpretive programs offered by park officials is "selling white history" (Cervený, 2007, p. 50). Indeed, the National Park Service interpreters are not required to be Indigenous, and the "white"/John Muir version of Glacier Bay history is being marketed and promoted onboard as likely this sells better than acknowledging the injustice of residential schools, village relocations, and oppression the X'una Kaawu and Tlingit faced as a result of government policy (see Shorty, 2016). An examination of the port description for ISP given to passengers by seven major cruise lines in 2022 reveals few mention X'una Kaawu history focusing instead on describing the physical landscape.

Final evidence of the shifting Indigenous focus is how Huna Totem brings in "outsiders" (as the community calls them) for management roles (see Wanasuk & Thornton, 2015). One of the benefits to the community in developing this port was the opportunity for local youth and members of the community to have access to training and jobs with career potential. This was seen as a way to entice younger members to return and stay in the community, as previously there were not many employment opportunities outside of resource extraction. As a tourism enterprise, ISP provides nearly 300 jobs in Hoonah, generating \$2.24 million in local wages (Icy Strait Point, 2018). When it opened, 94% of the jobs were held by local residents (Alaska Coastal Management Program, 2005), which dropped to 65% local hires in 2015 (City of Hoonah, 2016). Huna Totem noted in 2020 at least 85% are local (Huna Totem, 2020), yet many of the management roles are still filled by non-Indigenous people. Vogt et al. (2016) also found this to be a concern in Sitka, with residents there desiring jobs to be held by locals instead of being outsourced to nonlocals or companies who have no personal investment in the community.

However, Huna Totem encourages local artisans and independent businesses to lease space at the cannery and provides space for the Hoonah School Store where students can learn about entrepreneurship (Wanasuk & Thornton, 2015). Hillmer-Pengram (2016) noted tourism development should be Indigenous controlled for Indigenous benefit and more management roles should be filled from within the X'una Kaawu community at ISP. Leme-lin et al. (2012) noted increasing local control and self-governance improves socioeconomic conditions for host Indigenous communities. ISP is an example of this improvement and strengthening of culture but is countered with the inconsistent and shifting Indigenous focus.

Discussion

The challenge for the X'una Kaawu is similar to that of other communities developing cruise tourism for its perceived economic and cultural benefits. As Vogt et al. (2016) highlighted, there is a need for a collaborative planning process to better manage development and ensure all in the community have a voice. However, if community participation in decision-making is essential for successful tourism destinations, there are questions of where that leaves Hoonah and the X'una Kaawu whose lives have been transformed by the development of ISP. It would appear the voices of the X'una Kaawu and Hoonah residents were not listened to in the pier expansion as the new development is much larger than originally envisaged, but yet the economic and social benefits have strengthened the culture and provided much needed employment and opportunity. Although other scholars have researched ISP and Southeast Alaska over the last two decades, this current study provides a longitudinal lens of how an Indigenous community can benefit from tourism development but also highlights the ongoing challenges of the power cruise lines exert. Earlier works have focused on residents' concerns and planning (Cerveny, 2007) whereas this current study has examined specifically the pier expansion and how the port selection occurred. This adds to the literature as an example of the contested nature of port selection and the unequal power relationships existing between the X'una Kaawu, Hoonah, Huna Totem, and the cruise lines. The themes revealed

in this study assist in advancing knowledge about the challenges communities face particularly when developing tourism and to be aware of the political structures and political economy in addition to being more aware of the potential pitfalls and gains made through (un)sustainable tourism development, cruise or otherwise. Indeed, at time of writing Huna Totem is assisting another Native corporation, the Klawock Heenya, to develop its own cruise ship enterprise on Prince of Wales Island. This points to the perceived increased demand for Indigenous experiences in Alaska ports, although this is beyond the scope of this article and more research is needed to better understand this potential tourist motivation.

This research has identified the complexities surrounding the pier expansion and the transition of power away from the community to the cruise companies and in doing so highlights the intersectionality between power, culture, and community. Hoonah could seek greater access for local businesses to share in profits by having access to the port land or entrance to offer additional or complementary services, experiences, or products. There could also be a way to allow local residents access to the site and provide the community with opportunities for recreation and community use of the beach and fishing.

ISP also reveals how community-based development implies community control but as is also the case in other cruise destinations, the reality is the community ends up only involved but with little actual power in decision-making (see Jordan et al., 2013; Notzke, 1999). As one X'una Kaawu employee stated, "We own this place but we had no power to say or change things" (in Wanasuk & Thornton, 2015, p. 22). The discussion of Hoonah and ISP has revealed the critical balance between competing stakeholder groups and the need for collaboration between all to manage challenges. The blue economy framework acknowledges the globalized nature and mobility of cruise tourism, and the social, economic, and environmental impacts on communities connected with the ocean, but also identifies the unequal power relationships. ISP and the cruise sector should seek a more sustainable triple bottom line approach fully embracing the blue economy concept, with future research exploring the complex issues of cruise tourism development

particularly in Indigenous communities. Hillmer-Pegram (2016) highlighted the opportunities in tourism for Indigenous communities to enhance subsistence lifestyles with capitalist enterprises; in this way ISP is an example of successful entrepreneurship for the X'una Kaawu but still fails to address the challenges of development.

Although this research was conducted prior to the COVID-19 pandemic, the push for sustainability and destination stewardship as identified by CLIA in 2020 are key issues that remain relevant as the cruise industry returns to full operations. This is even more important given the rapid growth the new pier will bring to ISP. As ISP strives to benefit the community and balance economic growth, environmental sustainability, and social equity through the Indigenous narrative, care must be taken to ensure the power is equally distributed between the cruise industry, Huna Totem, X'una Kaawu, and the community of Hoonah, and this remains more important than ever after the COVID-19 pandemic. A more collaborative approach (see Jordan et al., 2013; Vogt et al., 2016, for the port of Sitka) between the X'una Kaawu, Huna Totem, and the people of Hoonah would be beneficial and help achieve a better balance between social, economic, and environmental impacts and embrace the blue economy pillars.

Conclusion

This study has revealed the complex and unequal relationships that can occur between ports, communities, and the cruise sector and provides a practical contribution by identifying challenges in developing cruise tourism. This is significant given the growth of the industry and the demand for new ports. This research provides a theoretical contribution by exploring the intersectionality between power, culture, and community and in doing so adds to the body of knowledge and understanding of tourism development, cruise tourism, and Indigenous tourism. The blue economy was used as a framework to critically examine the pier expansion and provides a unique theoretical approach for examining tourism development at a cruise port and considers not only the economic benefits but also the conservation of cultural landscapes and marine environments. ISP is a successful Indigenous tourism

enterprise with economic stability and strong recognition of cultural heritage yet there are still issues of access, exclusion, and unequal power relationships. The implications of the partnership with NCLH suggests ISP is following the same path as many other cruise destinations by allowing cruise companies to exert power over the community to achieve profits that benefit few. ISP and Hoonah have the opportunity to continue to go against the “floe” and serve as an example of how small Indigenous communities can go against industry pressure to conform and offer a unique cruise visitor experience and tourism product. This would seek to balance economic growth, environmental sustainability, and social equity, but ultimately provide a stronger voice for Indigenous communities.

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